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Abu Dhabi Media Office

KHALED, CANADIAN PRIME MINISTER REVIEW RELATIONS

Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi and Chairman of the Abu Dhabi Executive Council, yesterday attended an official dinner banquet hosted by Mark Carney, Prime Minister of Canada. During the dinner banquet, both sides reviewed UAE-Canada relations and ways to elevate them to new levels of cooperation and strategic partnership across various sectors, and discussing several issues and topics of mutual interest.

AI axes 100,000 jobs worldwide

Microsoft offers 60,000 staff buyouts as global job cuts mount

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

More than 100,000 jobs worldwide face cuts under company plans linked to artificial intelligence, automation and restructuring, as employers redirect spending and reduce staffing. Microsoft's latest offer of voluntary buyouts to 60,000 employees adds to the scale of the upheaval.

A tally of figures in a Reuters compilation points to roughly 103,000–105,000 potential reductions across technology, banking, manufacturing and other industries. The announcements span the period since October 2025 and include proposed cuts and plans extending over several years.

The estimate excludes Microsoft's latest buyout offer, which represents eligible employees rather than confirmed departures.

Thousands at individual firms

Amazon announced 16,000 corporate job cuts in January under an overhaul focused on AI and efficiency. Block outlined more than 4,000 reductions, nearly half its workforce, through an AI-focused restructuring.

WiseTech announced 2,000 cuts, equivalent to one-third of its global staff, as it integrated AI. Intuit outlined approximately 3,000 reductions, about 17 per cent of its workforce, while streamlining operations and increasing its AI focus.

Atlassian announced 1,600 cuts alongside a push into AI and enterprise sales. Cloudflare outlined more than 1,100 reductions, while Snap and Autodesk each announced approximately 1,000.

Banks account for some of the largest potential reductions. HSBC was weighing 20,000 cuts, while Standard Chartered outlined more than 7,000 over four years and Barclays announced approximately 5,000.

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Dubai approves over Dh2b urban growth plan

MOVE AIMS TO BOOST PROPERTY VALUE BY DH20B IN TARGETED AREAS

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, yesterday approved an urban development plan backed by investments exceeding Dh2 billion, aimed at creating integrated communities and increasing property values in targeted areas by Dh20 billion.

The Urban Centres Development Plan was approved during a meeting of The Executive Council of Dubai chaired by Sheikh Hamdan.

Sustainable growth

Announcing the decision in a social media post, Sheikh Hamdan said the plan would support sustainable growth and meet people's aspirations, with three priorities guiding its implementation: quality of life, economic returns, and infrastructure and cost efficiency.

The plan also aims to increase the proportion of residents living around metro stations to 74 per cent and raise public services coverage to 85 per cent.

Sheikh Hamdan said the development of integrated communities would contribute to an increase of Dh20 billion in the real estate value of the targeted urban centres.

> **Our goal remains to create greater opportunities, improve quality of life for the people of Dubai and build a better future for generations to come."**
>
> **Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum**

Population planning policy

At the same meeting, The Executive Council approved the Sustainable Population Planning Policy, intended to align Dubai's economic and population growth. The policy will also guide the development of public services according to the emirate's future needs.

The Council separately approved the Digital Authorisation System, which Sheikh Hamdan said would provide a unified and trusted government experience for residents and businesses.

"Dubai continues to advance ambitious development projects," Sheikh Hamdan wrote.

"Our goal remains to create greater opportunities, improve quality of life for the people of Dubai and build a better future for generations to come."



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